09-05 第二篇

Coral Reefs in Danger

Coral reefs are often called the "rainforests of the sea." They cover less than one percent of the ocean floor, yet they support about one quarter of all marine species. Colorful fish, sea turtles, sharks, and thousands of other creatures depend on coral reefs for food and shelter. [1] These underwater ecosystems are not only breathtakingly beautiful but also vital to the health of our oceans and the livelihoods of millions of people.

Coral reefs are built by tiny animals called coral polyps. Over hundreds or thousands of years, these polyps create massive limestone structures that become home to an incredible diversity of life. [2] The slow, patient growth of corals means that reefs that took centuries to form can be destroyed in just a few years by human activity.

The biggest threat to coral reefs today is climate change. As ocean temperatures rise, corals experience "bleaching"—they lose the colorful algae that live inside them and turn white. [3] If the water stays too warm for too long, the corals die, and the entire reef ecosystem collapses.

Pollution and overfishing also damage coral reefs. Chemicals from farms and cities wash into the ocean, smothering corals and reducing water quality. [4] Overfishing removes key species that help keep the reef healthy, disrupting the delicate balance that allows these ecosystems to thrive.

Efforts to save coral reefs are under way around the world. Marine protected areas, coral restoration projects, and stricter fishing rules all help. [5] Saving coral reefs is a race against time, but with global cooperation and determined action, there is still hope for these irreplaceable treasures of the sea.

选项

A. Coral reefs provide essential services not only to ocean life but also to coastal communities that rely on fishing and tourism. B. This fragility makes protecting existing reefs all the more urgent and important. C. Without their algae partners, corals cannot get the energy they need to survive and grow. D. These human-caused pressures combine with climate change to create a crisis for reef ecosystems worldwide. E. The future of coral reefs depends on the choices we make today about how we treat our planet's oceans. F. For example, Australia's Great Barrier Reef has lost more than half its coral since the 1990s.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前说众多海洋生物依赖珊瑚礁，空后说这些生态系统不仅美丽还对海洋健康和人类生计至关重要。A的"essential services not only to ocean life but also to coastal communities"概括双重价值，与后文"livelihoods of millions"呼应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前说珊瑚生长缓慢、经过数百上千年形成，空后说几百年形成的珊瑚礁几年就能被破坏。B的"This fragility"承接生长缓慢的脆弱性，"protecting existing reefs all the more urgent"概括保护的紧迫性。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说海温升高导致珊瑚白化、失去共生藻类，空后说如果持续高温珊瑚会死亡。C的"Without their algae partners"承接白化机制，"cannot get the energy they need to survive"解释白化导致死亡的原因。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说污染和过度捕捞损害珊瑚礁，空后说过度捕捞移除关键物种破坏平衡。D的"These human-caused pressures combine with climate change"概括多重威胁叠加，"crisis for reef ecosystems worldwide"升级问题严重性。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前说全球正在采取保护措施，空后说拯救珊瑚礁是与时间赛跑但仍有希望。E的"future of coral reefs depends on the choices we make today"承接保护行动，呼吁行动的紧迫性。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, Australia's Great Barrier Reef has lost more than half its coral since the 1990s.**：以For example开头，属具体案例数据；易误放[3]或[4]，但两空分别需白化机制解释和多重威胁概括，非个案数据。